

Phone, Internet & Devices

Staying connected shouldn't break the bank. There are federal and nonprofit programs that lower the cost of phone and internet service, and help you get an affordable computer or tablet. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

The Affordable Connectivity Program (ACP) ended in 2024 — ignore any site still advertising its \$30 internet credit. The programs below are the ones that actually work in 2026. A real program never charges a fee just to apply.

1 Lower Your Phone or Internet Bill (Lifeline)

Lifeline is the main federal program. It gives a monthly discount on phone OR internet service through participating providers.

☐ Lifeline — Federal Phone & Internet Discount

Up to \$9.25/month off phone or internet (up to \$34.25 on Tribal lands). Qualify if your income is at or below 135% of the federal poverty guidelines, or you get SNAP, Medicaid, SSI, or certain other benefits.

→ www.lifelinesupport.org

☐ Lifeline Survivor Benefit (Safe Connections Act)

Survivors of domestic violence or trafficking can get up to 6 months of emergency Lifeline support and separate a phone line from an abuser's plan.

→ www.lifelinesupport.org/survivor-benefit

2 Free or Low-Cost Phones

Some Lifeline providers include a free phone with the monthly service discount.

☐ Lifeline Provider Search

Find companies in your state that offer Lifeline — many include a free or very low-cost phone.

→ www.lifelinesupport.org/companies-near-me

☐ SafeLink & Assurance Wireless

Two of the largest Lifeline phone providers. Check eligibility and what device they offer.

→ www.safelink.com

3 Affordable Internet Plans

Many internet providers run their own low-income plans, often around \$10–\$30/month, separate from any federal program.

☐ Provider Low-Income Plans

Ask your internet company about their low-income plan. Common ones include Xfinity Internet Essentials, Spectrum, and AT&T Access.

→ Ask your internet provider directly

☐ EveryoneOn — Find Low-Cost Internet

Enter your ZIP code to find affordable internet offers and devices in your area.

→ www.everyoneon.org

4 Low-Cost Computers & Tablets

Nonprofits refurbish computers and sell them cheaply to people who qualify.

☐ PCs for People

Low-cost refurbished computers and low-cost internet for income-eligible people.

→ www.pcsforpeople.org

☐ Computers with Causes

Donated computers for people and families in need.

→ www.computerswithcauses.org

☐ Human-I-T

Affordable devices and internet for low-income households.

→ www.human-i-t.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Skip any ad still promising the \$30 “ACP” or “Emergency Broadband” internet credit — that program ended in 2024. Lifeline is the real, active program now.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

You can usually only get one Lifeline discount per household, and you choose phone or internet. Pair it with a provider’s own low-income plan to save the most.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized connectivity search

This guide covers the main national programs. For the best phone or internet deal where you live — including local providers and device giveaways — use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find it.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
